(a) coniferous forest
(b) dry deciduous forest
(c) mangrove forest
(d) tropical rain forest

Ans. (d): The hot and humid conditions make tropical rainforests an ideal environment for bacteria and other microorganisms. Because these organisms remain active throughout the year, they quickly decompose matter on the forest floor.
Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

Hydrosphere

25. With reference to the water on the planet Earth, consider the following statements :
1. The amount of water in the rivers and lakes in more than the amount of groundwater.
2. The amount of water in polar ice caps and glaciers is more than the amount of groundwater.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (b): Water in groundwater is 0.62% while in lakes and rivers it is 0.008 (Salt lakes)+0.009(freshwater lakes) + 0.0001 (rivers) = 0.0171. So, the statement 1 is not correct.
Water in polar ice caps and glaciers is 2% while in groundwater it is 0.62%. So, the statement 2 is correct.
Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

Agriculture

26. Among the following which one is the least water-efficient crop?
(a) Sugarcane (b) Sunflower
(c) Pearl millet (d) Red gram

Ans. (a): It takes about 210 litres of water to produce 1 kg of sugar cane. Water footprint of sunflower is 7– 9 litre per kg. Millets are sown in dry areas with minimal irrigation. Red gram requires 35 to 40 cm water, during its entire growth period. Optimum moisture is required during budding, flowering, and pod formation stages. As Red gram is a rain-fed crop grown in assured rainfall areas, usually it does not need any irrigation.
Hence option (a) is the correct answer.
temperature. Hence statement 3 is incorrect.

INDIAN CONSTITUTION & POLITY

Central/ State & Union Territory Parliamentary System

27. We adopted parliamentary democracy based on the British model, but how does on the British model, but how does our model differ from that model?
1. As regards legislation, the British Parliament is supreme or sovereign but in India, the power of the Parliament to legislate is limited.
2. In India, matters related to the constitutionality of the Amendment of an Act of the Parliament are referred to the Constitution Bench by the Supreme Court.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c): Parliamentary sovereignty is a principle of the UK constitution. It makes Parliament the supreme legal authority in the UK, which can create or end any law. Parliament of India is a creation of the Constitution and hence for that reason itself, it has its limitations too. Statement 1 is correct.
The Constitution (Forty-second Amendment) Act, 1976, inserted various articles in the Constitution to curtail, both directly and indirectly, the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court and the High Courts to review the constitutionality of laws. Statement 2 is incorrect.
Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.

28. With reference to the Union Government, consider the following statements :
1. N. Gopalaswamy Iyengar Committee suggested that a minister and a secretary be designated solely for pursuing the subject of administrative reform and promoting it.
2. In 1970, the Department of Personnel was constituted on the recommendation of the Administrative Reforms Commission, 1966, and this was placed under the Prime Minister's charge.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (d): 1st Administrative reforms committee suggested that a minister and a secretary be designated solely for pursing the subject of administrative reform and promoting it. Hence statement 1 is not correct.
In 1970, the Department of Personnel was constituted on the recommendation of the Administrative Reforms Commission, 1966, and this was placed under the charge of Cabinet Secretariat. In 1985, it was placed under the overall charge of the Prime Minister assisted by a Minister of State. Hence statement 2 is not correct the prime minister assisted by a minister of State.
Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

29. Constitutional government means
(a) a representative government of a nation with federal structure
(b) a government whose Head enjoys nominal powers
(c) a government whose Head enjoys real powers
(d) a government limited by the terms of the Constitution

Ans. (d): Constitutional government in essence is about constitutionalism which is about limited government. It is defined by the existence of a constitution—which may be a legal instrument or merely a set of fixed norms or principles generally accepted as the fundamental law of the polity— that effectively controls the exercise of political power. In many cases, constitutional government is used interchangeably with "constitutionally limited government" or "limited government".
Hence, option (d) is the correct answer.

30. What was the exact constitutional status of India on 26th January, 1950?
(a) A Democratic Republic
(b) A Sovereign Democratic Republic
(c) A Sovereign Secular Democratic Republic
(d) A Sovereign Socialist Secular Democratic Republic

Ans. (b): In original preamble, during 26th January – 1950, constitutional status of India was a, "Sovereign Democratic Republic".
Later, with 42nd Constitutional Amendment two more words were added to constitutional status of India are "socialist and secular".
Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

Fundamental Right/ Fundamental Duties & Directive Principle of State Policy

31. 'Right to Privacy' is protected under which Article of the Constitution of India?
(a) Article 15 (b) Article 19
(c) Article 21 (d) Article 29

Ans. (c) : The supreme court of India has held that right to privacy is a fundamental Right and it is protected under Article 21 of the Constitution of India.
Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.

32. A legislation which confers on the executive or administrative authority an unguided and uncontrolled discretionary power in the matter of application of law violates which one of the following Articles of the Constitution of India?
(a) Article 14 (b) Article 28
(c) Article 32 (d) Article 44

Ans. (a): Article 14 ensures that all citizens are equal and that no person shall be discriminated on the basis of sex, religion, race or place of birth. It ensures that there is a separation of power between the three wings of the government and the executive. By these methods, the constitution fulfils all the requirements of Dicey's theory to be recognized as a country following the Rule of Law. Thus, a legislation which confers on the executive or administrative authority, an unguided and uncontrolled discretionary power in the matter of application of law, will violate Rule of law as prescribed under Article 14. So, option (a) is correct answer.
Hence option (a) is the correct answer.

33. Under the Indian Constitution concentration of wealth violates :
(a) the Rights to Equality
(b) the Directive Principles of State Policy
(c) the Right to Freedom
(d) the Concept of Welfare

Ans. (b): In Indian constitution, part IV (Directive Principles of State Policy) Article – 39(c) says that "The operation of the economic system does not result in the concentration of wealth and means of production to the common detriment".
Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

34. What is the position of the Right to Property in India?
(a) Legal right available to citizens only
(b) Legal right available to any person
(c) Fundamental Right available to citizens only
(d) Neither Fundamental Right nor legal right

Ans. (b): The Forty Fourth Constitutional Amendment, 1978, deleted Articles 19(1)
(f) and 31 from Part III, the chapter on Fundamental Rights in the Constitution. Instead, it inserted Article 300A in a new chapter IV of Part XII of the Constitution, thereby depriving the 'right to property' of its 'fundamental right' status. Article 300A directs that - Persons not to be deprived of property save by authority of law.—No person shall be deprived of his property save by authority of law. Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

35. Which one of the following best defines the term 'State'?
(a) A community of persons permanently occupying a definite territory independent of external control and possessing an organized government
(b) A politically organized people of a definite territory and possessing an authority to govern them, maintain law and order, protect their natural rights and safeguard their means of sustenance
(c) A number of persons who have been living in a definite territory for a very long time with their own culture, tradition and government
(d) A society permanently living in a definite territory with a central authority, an executive responsible to the central authority and an independent judiciary

Ans. (a): In political science, the term "State" has a more specific and definite meaning- "word State means a community or society politically organized under one independent government within a definite territory. It alone has the prerogative of making laws. The lawmaking power derives from sovereignty, which is the most distinctive characteristic of the State.
Hence option (a) is the correct answer.

36. Consider the following statements :
1. In India, there is no law restricting the candidates from contesting in one Lok Sabha election from three constituencies.
2. In 1991 Lok Sabha Election, Shri Devi Lal contested from three Lok Sabha constituencies.
3. As per the existing rules, if a candidate contests in one Lok Sabha election from many constituencies, his/her party should bear the cost of by-elections to the constituencies vacated by him/her in the event of him/her winning in all the constituencies.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 2 and 3